

WHAT TO REMOVE FROM YOUR RESUME

Indian Fresher Off-Campus Edition • Eradicate 1990s Biodata Clutter & Protect Resume Real Estate

Guiding Principle: Resumes are contextual. In modern off-campus tech and corporate recruiting, vertical space is precious. Every line must demonstrate technical competence, problem-solving, or engineering scope. Distinguish between *general private-sector best practice* and *specific employer exceptions*.

Item to Remove	Why It Hurts Your Resume	Legitimate Exceptions (When to Keep)
1. Father's / Mother's Name & Occupation	Irrelevant to your technical ability. Wastes 2–3 lines. Standard tech recruiters view family details as archaic biodata relics.	Government job forms, PSU background checks, or specific campus placement biodata forms where explicitly mandated.
2. Marital Status, Religion, Caste & Gender	Completely irrelevant to professional hiring and introduces unconscious bias. Standard private employers do not evaluate this.	Statutory affirmative action / reservation forms in official government portals (UPSC/SSC/State PSCs).
3. Full Street Address & Door Number	Privacy risk when uploading to multiple job boards. Recruiters only need to know your current city and relocation willingness.	Physical document verification after receiving an offer letter; background checks. Use City, State on resume.
4. Candidate Photograph / Headshot	In Indian tech off-campus applications, photos waste space, risk bias, and can confuse text extraction in older optical parsers.	Aviation, hospitality, media/acting, modeling, or European countries (e.g. Germany/France) where photos are conventional.
5. Formal "Declaration" & Signature Block	"I hereby declare that all information..." wastes 4 lines of prime space. Submitting an application implies truthfulness.	Hard-copy physical submissions for traditional government, banking, or defense exams.
6. Skill Percentage Rating Bars (e.g. "Java: 85%")	Subjective and meaningless. Recruiters ask: "85% of what? Did you invent the compiler?" It invites difficult interview grilling.	None in technical engineering. Replace with real projects that demonstrate the skill in action.
7. Vague Hobbies ("Listening to music")	Listing generic leisure activities looks like white-space filler. It provides zero signal of teamwork or technical curiosity.	Keep only if exceptional and relevant (e.g. Open Source contributor, Tech community organizer, National chess medalist).
8. Middle School / Elementary School Records	Listing 8th grade marks or primary school awards displays lack of recent achievements. Keep only Class 12 & 10.	None. Freshers should focus on College, Class 12, and Class 10.
9. 25+ Disparate Skill Buzzwords	Listing every tool you ever looked at (Docker, Kubernetes, AWS, C, Python, Flutter, AI) damages credibility when quizzed.	List only skills you can defend in a live technical screen. Group skills cleanly by Language, Framework, and Tool.
10. "Career Objective" Paragraphs	"To obtain a challenging position in an esteemed company where I can enhance my skills..." is generic filler.	Replace with a 1-line crisp target title (e.g. "Aspiring SDE B.Tech CSE 2026") or jump directly to Education/Skills.

Self-Check Rule: If an item does not help a technical hiring manager decide to interview you, **delete it**. Reclaim that space for project architecture, GitHub links, and measurable outcomes.